

Speaker 1: Good morning [Participant's Name], my name is [Name], I am an [occupation] at [University] and this research that we are going to conduct now is about relationship quality. So the time is from 30 minutes to an hour, it depends a lot on your answers and I wanted to present to you the commitment term, which is basically you authorizing and being aware that this interview is voluntary, it is anonymous, so we will not link your name, your interview is being recorded just for transcription, so once it is done we will not use your image, the recording or anything, and after the interview if you didn't like some question or don't want to answer some questions just tell me you don't want to answer and we move to the next one and your response will not be used, okay? I will send it on [Social Media] just for you to have the document of this term, but as you authorize us I will just start the interview now, okay? I will send it on [Social Media] only at the end. Shall we start? Let's. I wanted to know how old you are and how long you and [Partner's Name] have been together?

Speaker 2: I am [41-45] years old, we have been together since [Year].

Speaker 1: Wow, I was born in [Year]. So, [21-25] years.

Speaker 2: Yes.

Speaker 1: Great, and do you have children?

Speaker 2: I have [1-5], [1-5] older and twins.

Speaker 1: That's great. Do you live with them, with your children?

Speaker 2: With all of them, yes, only the eldest is not at home now, she is in another place and studying.

Speaker 1: Great, okay. And what is your main source of income and your current profession?

Speaker 2: My profession is an [occupation] for [department], both [department] and [department].

Speaker 1: And how should I refer to [Partner's Name], as [Partner's Name] or your wife, which is easier for you?

Speaker 2: You can call her [Partner's Name], that's fine, or my wife, it's all good.

Speaker 1: I will use [Partner's Name] and wife, it's easier for me. Can you tell me the story of how you two met, your love story, how the relationship started?

Speaker 2: We met when I came to [Country]. I didn't have the means for a relationship, like many who come here with just a suitcase. I rented a spot in a boarding house, and after some months, the owner asked me to help a girl who was moving in, and that girl was [Partner's Name]. I helped her with her bags, and we started a friendship which soon turned into a relationship.

Speaker 1: I see, it was quite natural then, you met young.

Speaker 2: Yes.

Speaker 1: I understand. How would you compare the quality of your current relationship with [Partner's Name] to the relationships of people you know, close ones or family members? Would you say your relationship is of higher quality or lower quality?

Speaker 2: We do have daily conflicts, but the quality is good, very good. Compared to others, I believe ours is better, higher quality.

Speaker 1: And how would you compare the quality of your current relationship with previous relationships, if you had any?

Speaker 2: Much superior.

Speaker 1: Why is that?

Speaker 2: In everything, because it was very different. The trust, the honesty of who she is.

Speaker 1: It was more serious then. Like, when it was serious, you had those initial relationship meetings and talked a lot, right?

Speaker 2: Yes.

Speaker 1: And for you, what does a high-quality relationship need to have? What are the characteristics?

Speaker 2: First of all, trust and both behaving correctly with each other and mutual respect.

Speaker 1: I see. And a low-quality relationship?

Speaker 2: A low-quality relationship is based on lies, lack of trust. That is low quality.

Speaker 1: And for you, what is the most important thing in a relationship? I know it sounds like what you just answered, but if you have other characteristics or important things, please share.

Speaker 2: The most important thing really is respect and truthfulness, no matter what. You have to talk, sit down, and discuss what happened, what didn't happen.

Speaker 1: Exactly, discuss what's going on. That's the way to improve. Got it. And now a more philosophical, different question. For you, what does love mean? What does it mean to love? Are there different kinds of love? How do you see it?

Speaker 2: Love for me happened with my wife. If it weren't for her, maybe I wouldn't even be here due to my past life and all. She was persistent, she gave me direction and put me on the

right path. Today, thanks to her, I have [1-5] children, all in college. None of them went through what I did. None.

Speaker 1: Great. And it seems repetitive, but it's in the script. So, for you, how important is love in a relationship? Can a relationship survive without love? How much love is needed?

Speaker 2: A relationship cannot survive without love. That doesn't exist. You can't live with someone with conflicts and no love.

Speaker 1: So, love is 100% important, fundamental in a relationship?

Speaker 2: Absolutely. To unite two people, love is necessary on both sides.

Speaker 1: And how do you know [Partner's Name] loves you? What does she do that makes you sure she loves you?

Speaker 2: She is sincere, honest, and trustworthy, 100%. What she says, I know it's true without her needing to prove anything. Although she does go out of her way to prove it.

Speaker 1: And I don't have anything to hide from her, and she doesn't have anything to hide from me. We have access to each other's phones without any issues.

Speaker 2: Exactly. Speaking of challenges, what are the challenges you face in your relationship today?

Speaker 1: Oh, it involves many things, but today it is more financial. But we manage.

Speaker 2: Financial in the sense that you don't agree or that together you don't have the resources to do what you want? Is that the challenge?

Speaker 1: Yes, together we don't have the necessary resources, but we survive just fine. It's not a conflict between us, we are working on it together.

Speaker 2: Yes, exactly.

Speaker 1: So, no fights, no big disagreements?

Speaker 2: No, there are disagreements, but nothing major. Sometimes I act alone and buy something, and she questions if it was necessary at that moment. But we deal with it.

Speaker 1: I see. So, these are the kinds of divergences you have. You do something not serious, but then you discuss it. It doesn't negatively affect the relationship.

Speaker 2: No, it doesn't happen often. We only buy what we can afford. Nothing extravagant.

Speaker 1: And what strategy do you use to resolve this? For example, you bought a shirt, [Partner's Name] talks to you about it, and how do you solve it? She gets a bit upset, how do you solve that?

Speaker 2: We check if it was really necessary. If so, we move on.

Speaker 1: Great. And would you say your relationship is good for you? Why?

Speaker 2: It's always been good for me. My wife is everything to me. Without her, I might not be here.

Speaker 1: Because she guided you, right? She changed your life?

Speaker 2: Yes, completely. Responsibility, organization, vision for the future. We built a lot together.

Speaker 1: And do you believe the relationship changed her as well?

Speaker 2: Yes, but she is dealing with some personal issues right now. We are working on it together.

Speaker 1: And do you feel secure in your relationship?

Speaker 2: Yes, very secure. We've been together for [21-25] years. It's not easy to break such a bond overnight.

Speaker 1: You have learned to handle conflicts, right?

Speaker 2: Yes, when one is upset, the other calms down. We don't both get angry at the same time. We wait for the storm to pass.

Speaker 1: And you know it's normal to have disagreements, especially in a long relationship.

Speaker 2: Yes, it's natural. We are different people. And sometimes we bring external issues home, but we handle it.

Speaker 1: When things get tough, you take a break, maybe go for a walk?

Speaker 2: Yes, and when we come back, things are better. It's like waiting for the storm to pass.

Speaker 1: I see. Well, thank you for sharing. Now, I will show you an image, and I would like you to rate from 1 to 9 how true these statements are for you. I will read the statement for you to make it easier.

Speaker 2: Okay.

Speaker 1: My partner really listens to me. How true is this from 1 to 9?

Speaker 2: 9. She always listens to me, 100%.

Speaker 1: Great. And another statement: My partner cares about my needs. From 1 to 9?

Speaker 2: 9. She cares a lot, especially now with my health issues. She insists on my treatment.

Speaker 1: Wonderful. Now, if you don't want to answer these next questions, just let me know. They are related to your sexual life. Is that okay?

Speaker 2: Yes, it's fine.

Speaker 1: Have you had sexual relations lately? Lately is up to you to define.

Speaker 2: Yes.

Speaker 1: And how satisfied are you with it? Is it good, bad, do you want more or less?

Speaker 2: It's good. We are at an age where it's not like it used to be. Health and age affect it, but it's not the main part of our relationship.

Speaker 1: So, you understand that it has changed over time?

Speaker 2: Yes.

Speaker 1: Finally, how satisfied are you with your relationship overall? Completely satisfied, very satisfied, somewhat satisfied, etc.?

Speaker 2: Completely satisfied. I have nothing to complain about.

Speaker 1: And why is that?

Speaker 2: Because everything is good for me. My family, my home, everything is fine.

Speaker 1: Even though the financial situation is not perfect, you are doing your best?

Speaker 2: Yes, complaining doesn't help. We have to keep fighting.

Speaker 1: That's great. That was the last question, [Participant's Name]. Thank you very much and sorry for not interviewing you yesterday.

Speaker 2: No problem. Yesterday, I wouldn't have been able to do it. I'm feeling much better today.

Speaker 1: I'm glad you're better. Thank you. I will interview [Partner's Name] later today. Please don't discuss the interview with her until she has completed hers.

Speaker 2: Sure, no problem. Thank you.

Speaker 1: Thank you. Let me stop the recording now.